collegiate go to the MoD for concurrence, and the final results are declassified only some months later. Unofficially, I came to know that I had made the grade, once again for both the Command and Staff streams. That meant that I would have to move out on promotion quite soon. I took some leave and went to meet Veena in Colombo. Veena had a nice, modern two-room flat in Wellawetta called the Ben and Nancy Towers, not far from the seafront, with the Ramakrishna Mission right opposite. We spent a nice week together, taking walks on the beach and sampling the local delicacies. In view of my likely promotion and move, we decided that Veena should not renew her contract when the school term ended in June. I wondered about my old friends from my Trincomalee days and was able to locate Maj Shane Balthazar, who had retired as a Colonel. We went to his house for dinner and met his wife and children. We reminisced about those troubled days and he took out an album with photos of almost all the officers who had been with the Battalion then. I dare say that he had many more photos of me than I have myself.

The official results came out in October, and I was promoted in situ to the rank of Lt Gen in November 2016. Since I would have to take over a Corps soon, it was obvious that my stay in DGIS would not last long. As it so happened, my sojourn in DGSI lasted for barely seven months, but I feel I had made a difference. This much I know, that the DGIS, Lt Gen Matharu, was definitely sad to see me go.

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